Student Tank

The Future of Student Entrepreneurship

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Introduction

Student Tank is a digital-first platform designed to revolutionize student entrepreneurship by bridging the funding and mentorship gap for young innovators.
Many groundbreaking ideas from students never reach the market due to a lack of financial support, connections, and expert guidance.
Student Tank creates an inclusive ecosystem, connecting student entrepreneurs with investors and mentors without the need for personal networks or privileged backgrounds.

Problem Statement

A staggering 60% of Gen Z aspires to start their own business, but only 6% successfully secure funding, leaving a massive gap between potential and execution.

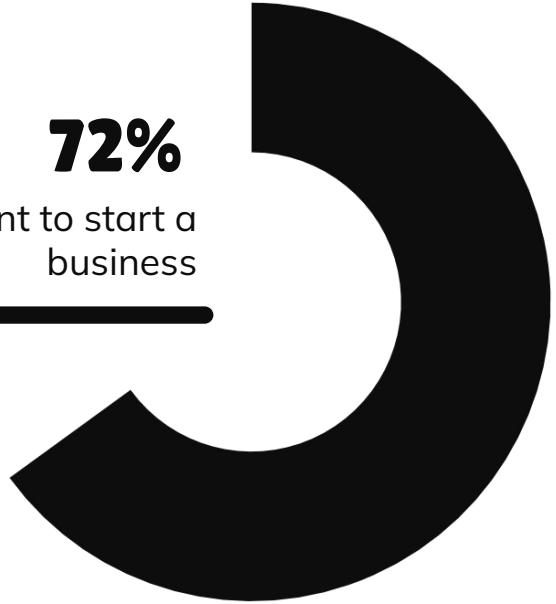
Traditional funding methods favor established entrepreneurs, making it nearly impossible for students with no credit history, business background, or investor connections to get financial support.
Banks reject students due to a lack of collateral, venture capitalists rarely consider inexperienced founders, and crowdfunding is often unpredictable and unreliable.

Without proper funding and mentorship, many promising ideas die before they even begin, leaving untapped potential in student innovation.

Research

Conducted with 150+ students, revealing that 72% want to start a business, but 61% cite funding as the biggest challenge. Additionally, 48% have no idea where to find investors or mentors.

Stakeholder Interviews: Case study with Thakur Developers highlighted that without pre-established credibility, young entrepreneurs struggle to gain investor trust.
Market Research: Despite facing financial hurdles, student-led startups still generate over $100 million annually, proving their potential if given the right support.



72%
Want to start a business

61%
Cite funding as their biggest challenge

Investor Focus Groups: Engage with angel investors, venture capitalists, and accelerator mentors to understand what makes student startups investable and how to align Student Tank with investor expectations.
University Partnerships: Collaborate with innovation and entrepreneurship departments at top universities to validate student business ideas and provide structured mentorship.
Competitive Analysis: Conduct a SWOT analysis of existing funding platforms like SeedInvest, AngelList, and Y Combinator to differentiate Student Tank and fill existing market gaps.

Proposed Method

Business Model Canvas

Business Model Canvas

DESIGNED FOR : Student Tank

DATE : 06 April 2025

DESIGNED BY : Group 04

KEY PARTNERS

ORGANIZATIONS

UNIVERSITIES
EDTECH PLATFORMS
STARTUP INCUBATORS

PEOPLE

VCS
ANGEL INVESTORS
MENTORS
AI DEVELOPERS

KEY ACTIVITIES

VIRTUAL PITCH EVENTS
AI-DRIVEN MATCHMAKING
UNIVERSITY PARTNERSHIPS
INVESTOR NETWORKING
MENTORSHIP PROGRAMS

KEY RESOURCES

AI-DRIVEN
MATCHMAKING SYSTEM
VIDEO HOSTING
PLATFORM
PARTNERSHIPS
MARKETING
INFRASTRUCTURE

VALUE PROPOSITIONS

DIGITAL-FIRST SHARK TANK FOR STUDENTS
AI-POWERED INVESTOR MATCHING
NO GEOGRAPHIC OR NETWORK BARRIERS

CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP

PERSONALIZED
MENTORSHIP,
SOCIAL MEDIA
ENGAGEMENT,
INVESTOR NETWORKING,
STARTUP SUCCESS
TRACKING

CHANNEL

UNIVERSITY NETWORKS
SOCIAL MEDIA
STARTUP EVENTS
EDTECH PARTNERSHIPS
INVESTOR NETWORKS

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

STUDENT ENTREPRENEURS
INVESTORS
STARTUP MENTORS
UNIVERSITIES

COST STRUCTURE

TECH INFRASTRUCTURE
MARKETING
PARTNERSHIPS
OPERATIONS

REVENUE STREAM

FREEMIUM MODEL
INVESTOR SUBSCRIPTIONS
SUCCESS FEES
SPONSORSHIPS
ADVERTISING

Proposed solution

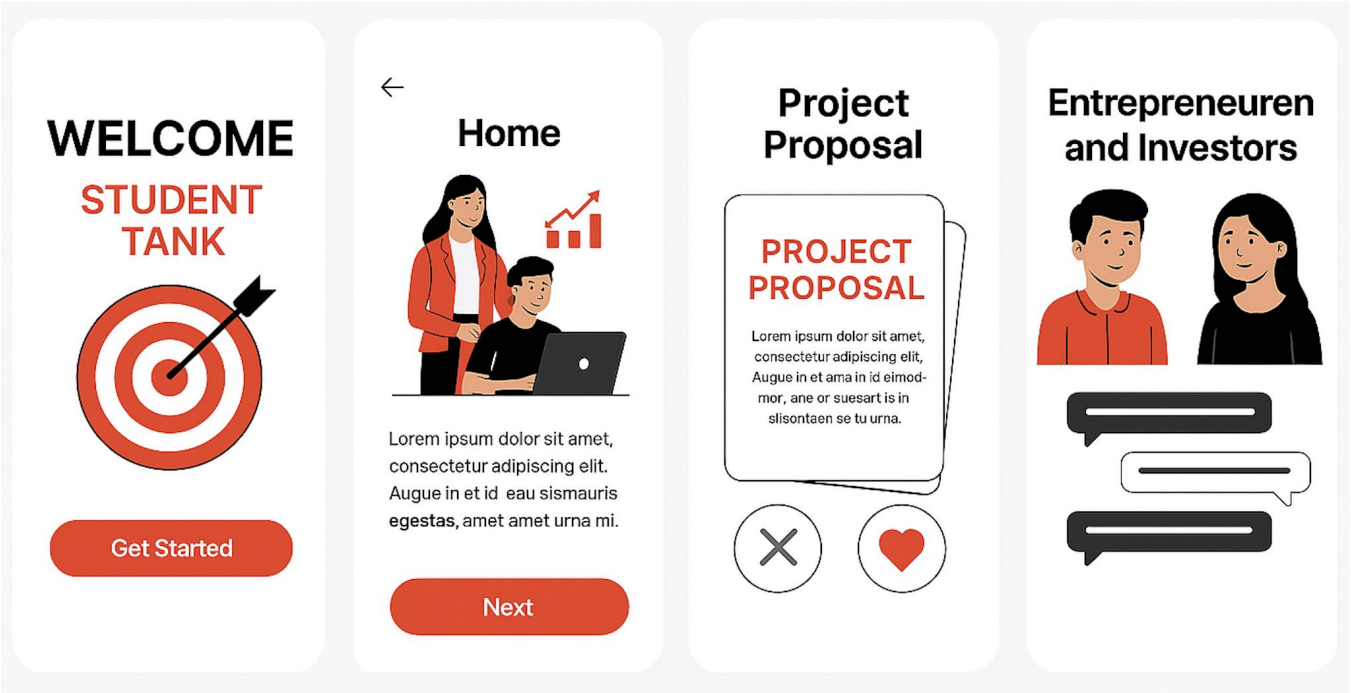
AI-Driven Matchmaking
Intelligently connects student startups with aligned investors based on industry trends, investor preferences, and startup potential.

Video-Based Pitch System
Replaces lengthy business plans with short, engaging presentations—making it easier for students to showcase creativity and potential.

Tiered Mentorship Program
Matches students with mentors based on startup stage and focus area, offering personalized guidance from ideation to launch.

University Verification Process
Ensures student identity and project authenticity, building investor trust and reducing risk in early-stage investing.

Prototype


WELCOME
STUDENT TANK
Get Started
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Entrepreneuren and Investors

SWOT Analysis

1 Strength

Digital-first platform removes geographic/networking barriers.

AI-powered investor-student matchmaking streamlines funding.

2 weakness

Heavy reliance on tech and AI accuracy.

Difficult to maintain balanced user growth early on.

3 Opportunity

Huge gap between Gen Z interest in startups and actual funding.

Leverages the shift to remote/digital engagement.

4 Threats

Investor skepticism about student-led ventures.

Economic downturns may slow investor activity.

Project Tools

Tech Stack Overview & Core Engines

AI Matching Engine

- TensorFlow-powered with 50+ data points for investor/startup profiling
- BERT-based NLP to extract business insights from pitch videos
- Fairness algorithms boost underrepresented founder visibility by 40%
- Improves match quality by 65% vs traditional methods

Pitch Video Platform

- AWS MediaConvert ensures seamless video delivery
- Drag-and-drop templates for professional-quality startup pitches
- Interactive features: product demos, financials, guided storytelling
- Investor engagement analytics (e.g., rewatch, completion rates)

Project Tools

Analytics, Security & Deployment Strategy

Analytics Dashboard

- Visualizes portfolio diversity, pitch traction, and market trends
- Predictive insights improve decision-making
- Integrated with Crunchbase, PitchBook, CB Insights

Security & Integration

- AES-256 encrypted communication
- API-based student verification via universities
- Escrow-enabled investment flow with milestone-based release

Implementation Strategy

- Phase 1: Top 50 universities→ Phase 2: 200+→ Phase 3: Open access
- Microservices via Docker & Kubernetes for modular scaling
- Real-time system monitoring with New Relic

Project Plan

Research & Planning

Conduct surveys, interviews, and define MVP features. Phase

Testing

Conduct usability tests, refine features, and improve AI accuracy.

Continuous Improvement

Monitor engagement, optimize AI recommendations, and refine platform usability.

1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5 — 6

Design & Development

Build a prototype with basic AI matching and pitch submission features.

Launch

Introduce the platform within university networks and begin investor onboarding

Expansion & Scaling

Expand Student Tank to more universities and integrate new funding models.

Conclusion

Student Tank democratizes startup funding, enabling young innovators to launch their businesses without traditional barriers.
The platform is scalable, data-driven, and AI-powered, making it an efficient solution for both students and investors.

By 2026, Student Tank aims to increase student startup funding by 300%, reduce investor sourcing costs by 40%, and foster a thriving global network of student entrepreneurs.

With the right funding, mentorship, and digital tools, the next generation of entrepreneurs will have the support they need to transform their ideas into reality.

Thankyou